
BIOGRAPHICAL SKETCH

NAME: Richelle W. Kihoro

eRA COMMONS USER NAME (credential, e.g., agency login): N/A

POSITION TITLE: Research Scientist

EDUCATION/TRAINING

INSTITUTION LOCATION	AND	DEGREE	Start Date MM/YYYY	Completion Date MM/YYYY	FIELD OF STUDY
University of Nairobi, Kenya		BSc	05/2013	09/2017	Microbiology and Biotechnology
University of Nairobi, Kenya		MPH	09/2019	12/2023	Public Health Epidemiology and Biostatistics

A. Personal Statement

I first became engaged in research during my undergraduate studies at the University of Nairobi, where I pursued a Bachelor of Science in Microbiology and Biotechnology. There I conducted a final year project supervised by Prof. Wolfgang Mukabana on identifying how economic creation activities in Lake Victoria facilitate the breeding of mosquitoes. This initial exposure to research laid a solid foundation for my subsequent endeavors. This led me to Kenya Medical Research Institute (KEMRI), where I volunteered as a Research Intern implementing the Early Infant Diagnosis (EID) program through conducting reverse transcription polymerase chain reaction (RT-PCR) assays for quantification of HIV on the Abbott m200 system and Roche CAP/CTM under principal investigator Prof. Matilu Mwau. Thereafter, I was recruited as a Research Scientist in KEMRI domiciled at Eastern and Southern Africa Centre of International Parasite Control (ESACIPAC). At ESACIPAC I am engaged in infectious and neglected tropical disease research on diseases such as soil-transmitted helminths, trachoma, lymphatic filariasis, schistosomiasis and COVID-19. At ESACIPAC I have conducted several serological analyses of dried blood spots (DBS) using the Bio-Plex Multiplex Immunoassay with the largest panel having over 46 different coupled antigens. I have also multiple conducted nucleic acid extraction and real time PCR experiments using the Step One Plus™ systems. At KEMRI I am also one of the participants selected for the KEMRI-JICA OMICS training under the Technical Cooperation Project for research capacity building of staff. I have been trained by Prof. Yoshito Fuji and Prof. Shingo Inoue on cell culture techniques, virus isolation techniques, expression and purification of recombinant protein in *E. coli* and bacterial identification by 16S rRNA gene sequencing. Overall, my extensive experience and training, coupled with my dedication to improving health outcomes, provide a strong foundation for my continued work in global health research. I am excited about the opportunity to further develop my skills and contribute to impactful research initiatives.

B. Positions, Scientific Appointments, and Honors**Positions and Scientific Appointments**

2021 – Present	Research Scientist, Kenya Medical Research Institute
2023 – Present	Member, Royal Society of Tropical Medicine and Hygiene
2020 – 2020	Research Assistant, University of Nairobi
2018 – 2019	Research Intern, Kenya Medical Research Institute
2017 – 2017	Laboratory Technologist Intern, Centre for Health Solutions
2016 – 2016	Student on Industrial attachment, Kenya Medical Research Institute
2014 – 2014	Student on Industrial attachment, National Public Health Laboratory Services